MILITARY SPECIFICATION

NEEDLES, HYPODERMIC, SPINAL PUNCTURE

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers spinal puncture hypodermic needles suitable for use in administering spinal anesthesia.

1.2 Classification. Needles shall be of the short bevel point design, and of the following sizes as specified (see 6.1).

Size 18. 18 Gage, 3-1/2 inch needle length.
Size 20. 20 Gage, 3-1/2 inch needle length.
Size 22. 22 Gage, 3-1/2 inch needle length.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665	Box, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Setup.

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Military

MIL-L-10547 Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publication. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA (USA) STANDARDS INSTITUTE
USA Z70.1-1955 American Standard Dimensions of Glass and Metal Luer Tapers for Medical Applications.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the United States of America Standards Institute, 10 East 40th Street, New York, New York 10016).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Cannula. Cannula shall be fabricated from seamless drawn, or welded and drawn tubing; material shall be class 3, type 304 in accordance with GG-I-526.

3.1.2 Hub. Hub shall be fabricated from brass, nickel plated, or chromium over nickel plated in accordance with plating requirements for class 8 material of GG-I-526. The corrosion tests shall be the salt-spray and boil tests. The hub shall be polished.

3.1.3 Stylet.

3.1.3.1 Stylet wire. The wire of the stylet shall be fabricated from class 3, type 304 material in accordance with GG-I-526.

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3.1.3.2 Stylet knob. The stylet knob shall be fabricated from brass, nickel plated, or chromium over nickel plated in accordance with plating requirements for class 8 material of GG-I-526. The corrosion tests shall be the salt-spray and boil tests. As an alternate, the stylet knob shall be fabricated from austenitic stainless steel; the corrosion tests shall be in accordance with GG-I-526 for class 3 material.

3.2 Style, design, dimensions, and construction.

3.2.1 Cannula dimensions. The length of the cannula (measured from the tip of point to the junction with the hub) shall be as specified in table I, column 3. The cannula shall have additional length sufficient to extend well into the hub. Outside diameter of the needle called for in the invitation for bids shall be specified by gage number, and shall be as specified in table I, columns 4 and 5. Inside diameter of the needle shall be as specified in table I, column 6. The length of point of the needle (measured from heel to tip parallel with axis of cannula) shall be as specified in table I, column 2.

3.2.1.1 Cannula construction. The cannula shall extend into the hub sufficiently to allow for secure staking. In accordance with standard practice, the extension of the needle cannula into the hub shall not be such as to prevent the stylet from being readily inserted into the needle cannula lumen or to create areas for possible accumulation of materials. The cannula shall be securely swaged (not soldered) into the hub so as to be concentric with the hub cavity. The cannula shall not deviate from the central longitudinal axis of the needle by more than 3 degrees.

Table I. Dimensions of needles

Gage (1)	Length of Point ± 10 percent (inch) (2)	Cannula (inch)			
		*Length ± 1/8 inch (3)	Outside Diameter		Inside Diameter (Lumen) Minimum measured at Point (6)
			Maximum (4)	Minimum (5)	
22	0.0937	3-1/2	0.0285	0.0275	0.0155
20	0.109	3-1/2	0.036	0.034	0.022
18	0.125	3-1/2	0.0505	0.0475	0.0315

* Dimensions shown in this column shall be used as needle length in specifying sizes.

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3.2.1.1.1 Needle point. The needle point shall be of the short bevel design. The bevel shall be ground concave or flat and shall have a center ridge at the distal end to strengthen the tip; shall be so ground at the outer end as to enhance the keenness of the tip and cutting edges. The outer edges of the ground surface shall be keen and both outer and inner edges shall be free from burrs and slivers. The tip shall be straight and strong and of maximum keenness.

3.2.2 Hub. Shall be Luer-lock hub, so shaped as to provide means for facilitating attachment to, and removal from, a syringe. Except as specified below, the hub and hub cavity shall be in accordance with figure 3 of United States of America (USA) Standard Z70.1-1955 and shall meet the requirements specified in 3.2.2.1. The hub shall be so shaped that it shall not roll, and shall provide a satisfactory finger grip for attaching the needle to a syringe. The hub shall have a flange on the edge of the skirt. The flange shall satisfactorily engage the helical groove (or similar equal element) common to locking devices on certain American-made syringes. The entire hub cavity wall, down to the entrance of the lumen, as well as the exterior of the hub, shall be properly plated. The edge of the hub shall be slotted to receive the guide provided on the stylet knob (see 3.2.3.2).

3.2.2.1 Diameter and depth of Luer hub cavity. The hub cavity shall be tested for diameter and depth of Luer hub cavity as specified in 4.4.7. Hubs which do not fit the plug gage within the "GO" - "NO GO" limits specified in 4.4.7, shall be rejected. In addition, when the hub is fitted onto the plug gage as specified in 4.4.7, there shall be no movement of the hub on the gage when the cannula is pressed lightly from side to side in all directions.

3.2.3 Stylet. Each needle shall be fitted with a stylet. The stylet wire shall extend into the stylet knob to allow for secure staking or crimping. The stylet wire shall be securely swaged or crimped (not soldered) into the stylet knob in a concentric fashion, to allow proper insertion of the stylet into the needle hub and cannula.

3.2.3.1 Stylet wire. The stylet wire shall be capable of easy insertion into, and withdrawal from, the needle. The wire shall be of adequate length to permit one end to be permanently secured into the stylet knob, and the opposite end to be ground flush with the cutting edge of the cannula (that is, the beveled point of the cannula). The wire shall be of sufficient diameter to prevent movement of the stylet which might permit the cut tip of the stylet to be bent while the stylet is in position in the needle (that is, bevel of the stylet tip shall blend with bevel of point of the cannula presenting a single uniform surface with point of cannula).

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3.2.3.2 Stylet knob. The stylet knob shall be of conventional design having a taper tip that shall properly fit the Luer-taper slip of the needle hub, and a guide of adequate style and design to make a positive fit into the slotted edge of the needle hub and hold the ground edge of the stylet wire in proper position. The slot and guide shall be aligned with, and on the same side as the beveled surface of the cannula point.

3.3 Freedom from foreign matter. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the hub cavity shall be substantially free from chips and other foreign matter. In addition, a visual examination of the cannula lumen shall reveal no presence of foreign matter, chips, burrs, or occlusion of the lumen.

3.4 Security of assembly. When tested as specified in 4.4.2, the cannula shall not loosen or pull out of the hub, and the stylet wire shall not pull out of the stylet knob.

3.5 Stiffness. When tested as specified in 4.4.3, the maximum deflection of the cannula shall not exceed the following distances, in inches, for the appropriate needle gage.

GAGE	MAXIMUM DEFLECTION
22	0.029 inch
20	0.021 inch
18	0.017 inch

3.6 Fluid tightness. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, the connection of the cannula with the hub shall not show leakage, and the Luer connection of the hub with the taper test gage shall not show leakage exceeding the formation of a falling drop.

3.7 Elasticity. When tested as specified in 4.4.5, the cannula shall show no permanent set (that is, the cannula shall return fully to starting point).

3.8 Resistance to breakage. When tested as specified in 4.4.6, the cannula shall not break or show any indication of deformation.

3.9 Identification marking.

3.9.1 Needles. The spinal puncture needles shall have the gage number and contractor's name or registered trademark permanently and legibly marked on the needle hubs.

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3.9.2 Stylet knob and needle hub. The stylet knob and needle hub shall be permanently and legibly marked with a corresponding serial number (or serial number and letter). There shall be no duplication of serial numbers among needles of the same type and size delivered on any particular contract. When it is necessary to use more than two characters for a serial number, then two or three alphabetical characters shall be used with the exception that the "O" and the "I" of the alphabet shall not be used.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Needles shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability. The cannula shall show a smooth finished outer surface, free from pits, tool marks, burrs, scale or corrosion; and inner surface free from scale, deep pits, deep furrows, or die marks; the lumen of the cannula and the hub cavity shall be free from burrs, chips, dirt, slivers, or other foreign matter. Needles shall be sharp, not blunt or bent, and points shall be free from feathered edges, burrs, or other defects, when examined under 7 power (7X) magnification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties).

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table II.

Table II. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major A	S-4	1.0
Major B	S-1	1.0
Minor A	S-4	6.5
Minor B	S-1	4.0

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table III.

Table III. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Reqmt.	Test procedure	Unit of product	Insp. level	AQL
Needle cannula and stylet wire.	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	1 needle	S-1	*
Needle hub and stylet knob	Boil test (For all material)	3.1.2 and 3.1.3.2	GG-I-526	1 needle	S-1	*
	Salt-spray (For Class 8 material)	3.1.2 and 3.1.3.2	GG-I-526	1 needle	S-1	*
	Plating Test	3.1.2 and 3.1.3.2	GG-I-526	1 needle	S-1	*
Needle cannula	Dimensions	3.2.1	---	1 needle	S-1	*
	Stiffness Test	3.5	4.4.3	1 needle	S-1	*
	Elasticity Test	3.7	4.4.5	1 needle	S-1	*
	Resistance to Breakage	3.8	4.4.6	1 needle	S-1	*

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Table III (Cont'd)

Component	Characteristic	Reqmt.	Test procedure	Unit of product	Insp. level	AQL
Needle Hub	Diameter and Depth of Luer Hub Cavity	3.2.2.1	4.4.7	1 needle	S-1	*
Spinal Puncture Needle	Freedom from Foreign matter	3.3	4.4.1	1 needle	S-1	*
	Security of Assembly	3.4	4.4.2	1 needle	S-1	*
	Fluid Tightness	3.6	4.4.4	1 needle	S-1	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

4.2.3 Raw materials. Sufficient quantity of each lot of each metal used in the construction of the needles shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.2.4 Test samples. Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination. The needles shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables II and IV. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table IV. Any needles in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and, if the number of defective needles in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

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Table IV. Classification of Defects in accordance with MIL-STD-105

Categories	Defects
Critical:	None defined
Major A:	
101	Cannula lumen not free from obstructions.
102	Cannula lumen not free from scale, burrs, chips, dirt, deep pits, deep furrows, die marks, or other foreign material.
103	Cannula outer surface not smoothly finished or free from pits, tool marks, burrs, scale, or corrosion.
104	Cannula not free from cracks.
105	Cannula not concentric with hub.
106	Cannula outside diameter not as specified.
107	Point missing.
108	Point blunt or bent, not sharp, not symmetrical or properly formed, or not free from burrs, feathered edges, or other detrimental defects (examined under 7X magnification).
109	Point does not face flat of hub.
110	Hub not free from cracks, pits, or tool marks.
111	Hub not free from burrs, slivers, or plating not free from flaking.
112	Hub not nickel plated down to entrance of lumen, as well as exterior.
113	Hub cavity diameter and depth not in accordance with USA Standard as specified.
114	Hub indexing slot missing, or does not make proper fit with stylet flange.
115	Hub indexing slot not lined up with cannula point as specified.
116	Stylet missing.
117	Stylet tip not flush with cannula point.
118	Stylet outside diameter not as specified (fit).
119	Stylet flange missing, or not effective.
120	Stylet makes sloppy fit with needle.
121	Serial numbers (on hub and stylet) missing, incomplete, not legible or incorrect.
122	Serial number duplication (each duplication shall be counted as a defective unit).
Major B:	
151	Cannula inside diameter not as specified.
152	Point length not as specified.

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Table IV (Cont'd)

Categories	Defects
Minor A:	
201	Discoloration of outside surfaces of needle or stylet.
202	Cannula length not as specified.
203	Cannula deviates from central longitudinal axis of needle by more than 3 degrees.
Minor B:	
251	Identification marking missing, incomplete, not legible or incorrect.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Freedom from foreign matter test. The Luer cavity shall be examined under 7X magnification and good illumination for chips and other foreign matter. In addition, a cotton swab, tightly wrapped on the end of a small wooden applicator, shall be vigorously turned down into the bottom of the cavity, withdrawn, and examined for chips and other foreign matter under 7X magnification and good illumination. The cannula shall be tested for blockage by inserting a wire through the lumen of the cannula.

4.4.2 Security of assembly. A straight pull of 10 pounds shall be applied between the cannula and hub, and the stylet wire and stylet knob for a period of one minute for 22 gage needles. For the 18 and 20 gage needles, a straight pull of 15 pounds shall be applied in the same manner as for the 22 gage needles.

4.4.3 Stiffness test. The cannula shall be placed across two test edges (0.002 inch radius maximum) separated by the distance indicated in table V for appropriate gage. A load, as indicated in table V, shall be applied at the center of the span, and the resulting maximum deflection of the cannula shall be measured using a gage with graduations of at least 0.001 inch. The force shall be applied through an edge with a maximum radius of 0.036 inch, and centered to within $\pm$ 0.003 inch.

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Table V. Stiffness test

Gage	Separation of test edges, inch (± 0.003 inch)	Load, ounces (± 1/4 ounce)
22	0.625	50
20	0.750	50
18	1.000	70

4.4.4 Fluid tightness test. With the needle in a horizontal position, the needle hub shall be attached by means of a plug gage, as shown in figure 5 of USA Standard Z70.1-1955 (except that gage shall have been provided with a fluid path), to a water pressure source having a pressure gage. The water shall be permitted to run through the needle so as to fill the cavity space and the lumen of the cannula. The lumen shall then be sealed, and a pressure of 45 pounds per square inch gage (psig) shall be applied for 10 seconds.

4.4.5 Elasticity test. The needle hub shall be placed in a fixed position. The cannulae shall be bent (cannulae without permanent set) to one side as indicated below, for the appropriate gage, and then released:

Gage	Bend (degrees)	Contact distance, from hub (inches)
22	12	11/16
20	13	1
18	12	1-1/4

4.4.6 Resistance to breakage. The needle hub shall be clamped in a fixed position. A force shall be applied to the cannula at a point as specified in 4.4.5 (contact distance) for the appropriate needle size, to bend the cannula in a clockwise direction through an arc of 25 degrees, from the original, neutral position. A force shall then be applied in a counterclockwise direction (without changing contact distance) to bend the cannula past its neutral position and to an angle of 25 degrees. The needle cannula shall then be returned to its original neutral position. The test described above shall be repeated 20 times.

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4.4.7 Diameter and depth of Luer hub cavity. The Luer hub cavity shall be tested with the male Luer taper gage of figure 5 of USA Standard Z70.1-1955 (this gage shall be as shown in the USA Standard, except that it shall be constructed with a suitable fluid path to permit performance of the fluid tightness specified in 4.4.4). The needle hub shall be slipped on this gage with very little pressure. The fit of the needle hub on this gage shall be tested by means of the feeler gage in accordance with figures 5 and 6 of USA Standard Z70.1-1955.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One needle, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in table VI shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table VI. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	25 units	250 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Unit package. Each needle (1 unit) shall be packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Commercial colors will be acceptable. As an alternate, each unit shall be packaged in a plastic container of appropriate size and design fabricated of polyethylene or other suitable material. The carton or plastic container shall be enclosed in a heat sealed envelope of appropriate size and design which shall permit sterilization of contents. Needle shall be secured within the carton or plastic container in such a manner that the point will not be damaged. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.3.2 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Commercial colors will be acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, style 3, for class 3 use; PPP-B-601, table II, using type I, class 1 plywood; PPP-B-621, table III; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Strapping shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.3 Closure. Closure of wood boxes shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification. Closure of each fiberboard box shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4, of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall conform to PPP-B-601, table I, using type III, class 1 plywood; or shall be designed for type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, style 3, for class 2 use; PPP-B-621, table I; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2)
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)

6.2 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet Military requirements.

Custodians:
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Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Review activities:
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CAUTION

NOTICE TO BIDDERS/OFFERORS

DO NOT CONDITION OR BASE YOUR BID/OFFER ON ANY CURRENT PROCUREMENT ON THE INFORMATION SUBMITTED ON THIS FORM SINCE ANY CHANGES OR DELETIONS IN THE SPECIFICATIONS MAY RENDER YOUR BID/OFFER NON-RESPONSIVE IN WHICH CASE IT CANNOT BE CONSIDERED FOR AWARD.

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document-(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements .

SPECIFICATION

MIL-N-36546

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64, WHICH MAY BE USED.

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